

- Formula: Receive -> Appreciate -> Summarise -> Ask
- Move: receive the person fully, appreciate the contribution or feeling, summarise the core meaning, then ask one useful follow-up
- Minimum: I am hearing X. I appreciate Y. The key point seems to be Z. What would be useful to explore next?
- Best for: active listening, sensitive conversations, coaching, mentoring, reflective supervision and moments when someone needs to feel accurately heard
- Avoid when: urgent instruction, legalistic correction, high-risk decisions needing direct action, or moments when summarising could feel premature
- Failure mode: performing the four letters mechanically instead of genuinely listening